

\$1 billion decline

Facebook founder Mark Zuckerberg doesn't seem to be carried away by wealth. He recently turned down a \$1-billion offer for his social networking business

YouTube live

Video hosting web site YouTube is testing the possibility of live video streaming as a service

Sony Computer Entertainment (SCE) and Microsoft have big releases this winter with the launch of motion-control peripherals for their respective consoles. It looks like SCE will be first among the two to launch its motion controller in the Indian market, with is expected to be already on sale by the time you are reading this. Microsoft's Kinect is expected to follow shortly as the official word is that they are committed to a launch before the year ends. In this issue, we will look at PlayStation Move, its technology and our hands-on impressions of the system. In the next issue we hope you bring you a more detailed review of PlayStation Move and impressions on Microsoft's Kinect.

Eye on the Orb

The basic setup required to add motion sensing capabilities to PlayStation 3 includes a PlayStation Eye camera and a PlayStation Move motion controller. PlayStation Eye is a camera that can capture images at frame rate of 60 hertz at 640×480 pixel resolution, and 120 hertz at 320×240 pixels. The camera has been around in the market for a few years now, but it seemingly has not caught on among PlayStation 3 users. Reasons for this could be the device's dismal performance under certain lighting conditions, the constant need for calibration and its rudimentary capturing capabilities, which made for less than inspiring applications. The camera's performance in detecting motion has been infinitely improved with the introduction of PlayStation Move controller. The camera is better at tracking the movements because the controller has its own light source in the form of a glowing orb on the top. The LEDs inside the orb is capable of dynamically changing color depending on rooms lighting conditions. The orb's dynamic lighting ability also allows the camera to distinguish between different controllers when there is more than one in use. This has also reduced processing latency since the camera only needs to track the orb as opposed to the need to track entire scene, before Move was introduced.

Sensors

The camera and the glowing orb are not the only things that are part of Move's motion sensing technology. The Move controller has a three-axis gyroscope, three-axis accelerometer and a terrestrial magnetic field sensor.



PlayStation Move: First Impression

The gyroscope and accelerometer combine to form the controller's inertial sensors that can not only track movement in all three-axis but also detect subtle movements like twisting of the wrist. The magnetic field sensor (magnetometer) tracks the controller's orientation in relation to Earth's magnetic field. This third sensor compensates for drift and allows the system to keep track of the controller even when it is hidden from the camera, with the help of dead reckoning algorithms. The information from these sensors is sent to the console using Bluetooth.

Move Controller

It is relieving to see that Sony has already included vibration feedback support from the start, unlike what they did with the Six Axis controller. On the outside, the controller has smaller version of all the four game buttons

(circle, triangle, square and X) and the new 'Move' button in front. The Start and Select button are on the sides and the back of the controller has a single trigger button with better tactile feel than the standard controllers. The four game buttons are a little too small and are hard to press. Thankfully, all the game demos we tried barely make use of these buttons and this practice is likely to continue.

Navigation controller

The Move navigation controller is meant for games that require a combination of gamepad controls and gestures. This is technically an optional add-on since the system allows the use of Dual Shock 3 or Six Axis controller instead of the navigation controller. However, as you can imagine, using the gamepad with one hand is easier said than done. This one-handed navigation controller has

